



LME KNITTING PATTERN

BUCKET HATS FOR BABY AND CHILD, DUPLICATE STITCH

NORGE · NORWAY · RO · SIZE 50-104

The same bucket hat as the NORGE and RO patterns for adults, graded completely from scratch into ten baby and child sizes, 50 to 104. Here you knit the whole hat in one colour first, then embroider the letters and flag on afterwards with duplicate stitch, just like the adult “NORGE bucket hat” pattern. Smaller letters were designed just for the smallest heads. This pattern is complete on its own, you do not need any other LME pattern to knit it.



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TIPS: Read the whole pattern once before you cast on. Always knit a gauge swatch first, see page 4.

BEFORE YOU START

The bucket hat is knitted in the round on a circular needle or double-pointed needles, from the bottom up, in a single colour throughout. You start with a striped brim that flares, then the main body straight up, and finally decrease the crown down to a small rounded top. Right at the end you embroider the motif on with duplicate stitch (also called Swiss darning), a stitch that sits on top of the knitting and looks knitted in. This pattern covers three motifs, pick the one you want to make:

- **NORGE:** the word embroidered in white across the forehead
- **NORWAY:** the same, but with the English name
- **RO:** the RO letters plus a small Norwegian flag, solid blue brim

WHAT YOU LEARN

- To knit a hat in the round on a circular needle or double-pointed needles
- To knit a striped, flared brim with a decrease round
- To embroider a letter or flag motif with duplicate stitch, following a chart
- To decrease a rounded crown evenly down to a few stitches

HOW HARD IS IT?

Beginner friendly. You should be able to cast on, knit stockinette in the round and change colour. The hat itself is knitted in just one colour at a time, the motif comes on afterwards with a needle and thread, and every step is spelled out in this pattern.

Use double-pointed needles or magic loop for the smallest sizes (50–86). An ordinary circular needle is often too long for the stitches to reach round.

SIZES AND GETTING THE FIT RIGHT

The clothing size is only a guide. Always measure around the child's head, above the ears and eyebrows. Go by the head measurement if it and the clothing size point to different sizes.

Size	Approx. age	Head (cm)
50	0-1 mo	34-36
56	1-2 mo	36-38
62	2-4 mo	38-40
68	4-6 mo	40-42
74	6-9 mo	42-44
80	9-12 mo	44-46
86	12-18 mo	46-48
92	18-24 mo	48-50
98	2-3 yr	49-51
104	3-4 yr	50-52

SAFE USE FOR THE YOUNGEST

The hat is a garment for supervised, awake use. It should not be used during sleep, in a cot, in a pram unattended, or if the brim covers the eyes, nose or mouth. Always check that no loose threads or long floats on the inside can catch on little fingers.

Children grow at different rates. The actual head measurement always beats age, measure again whenever you are unsure.

WHAT YOU NEED

YARN

A smooth cotton yarn (aran weight) that gives 17 stitches x 22 rounds in stockinette = 10 x 10 cm on 5 mm needles. Reynolds Saucy, Rico Design Creative Cotton Aran and Hobbii Amigo are all good choices, in red, white and navy.

Colour

Use

● Red	main colour, whole hat
○ White	embroidery: letters, stripes
● Navy	stripes, embroidery: flag, RO brim

Have plenty of red main colour (almost the whole hat is knitted in red) and one small ball each of white and navy, they are only used in the brim stripes and the embroidery.

NEEDLES AND KIT

- 5 mm circular needle, 40 cm, or 5 mm double-pointed needles/magic loop set
- **Tapestry needle with a blunt tip** for the embroidery, a sharp needle can split the yarn
- Scissors and tape measure
- Stitch marker (optional, to track centre front)

**If you knit tightly, try 5.5 mm needles. If you knit loosely, try 4.5 mm.
The target is always 17 stitches over 10 cm.**

GAUGE, THE SECRET KEY

KNIT A SWATCH FIRST

Cast on 30 stitches in the main colour. Knit stockinette in the round (or back and forth with an edge) until the swatch is at least 12 x 12 cm. Wash and dry it the way you plan to treat the hat, then measure across the middle.

- More than 17 stitches over 10 cm: try a thicker needle.
- Fewer than 17 stitches over 10 cm: try a thinner needle.
- Exactly 17 stitches: use 5 mm needles and get going.

GLOSSARY

Term	Means
st	stitch
round	one whole lap around
k	knit
k2tog	knit 2 stitches together, decreases one stitch
MC	main colour (red)
duplicate stitch	embroidery that sits on top of the knit stitches and looks knitted in, also called Swiss darning
evenly spaced	spread equally around the round, not bunched in one spot

PART 1: CAST ON AND KNIT THE BRIM

- 1 Find the number for your size in the «Cast on» column in the table on the next page. Cast on exactly that many stitches in red main colour.
- 2 Check that the cast-on edge is not twisted around the needle. Join in the round and place a stitch marker at the start of the round, this is where every round begins and ends.
- 3 Knit the brim in stockinette in the round (knit every stitch), for the number of rounds in the «Brim rounds» column. Change colour following the stripe suggestion in the table: knit each stripe for the stated number of rounds before switching to the next colour.
- 4 RO hat: skip the stripes and knit the whole brim in navy instead.
- 5 On the very last brim round, knit 2 stitches together all the way round (stitch 1 and 2 together, stitch 3 and 4 together, and so on). This halves the stitch count exactly, from your cast-on number down to the «Main body» number on the next page.

THE FLARED EDGE

The decrease round is what gives the brim its characteristic flared, wavy edge, it is normal for the edge to curl in a little until the hat has been worn a few times.

TABLE: THE BRIM, ALL SIZES

Size	Cast on	Brim rounds	Stripe order (NORGE/NORWAY)
50	116	6	2 red, 1 white, 1 blue, 1 white, rest red
56	122	7	2 red, 1 white, 1 blue, 1 white, rest red
62	130	8	2 red, 2 white, 2 blue, 1 white, rest red
68	136	9	2 red, 2 white, 2 blue, 1 white, rest red
74	144	10	2 red, 2 white, 2 blue, 1 white, rest red
80	150	11	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
86	156	12	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
92	162	13	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
98	166	13	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red
104	170	13	3 red, 2 white, 3 blue, 2 white, rest red

Use double-pointed needles or magic loop for the whole brim on the smallest sizes, it is too narrow for an ordinary circular needle.

PART 2: THE MAIN BODY

- 1 After the decrease round, knit stockinette in the round in the main colour, all the way, with no pattern. This is now the main body of the hat, the part that shows the most.
- 2 Knit plain until the whole main body measures the «Height to top» value in the table on the next page, measured from the decrease round. Do not worry about the motif yet, you embroider that on at the end, see Part 3 on the next spread.

TABLE: MAIN BODY

Size	Stitches (main body)	Height to top
50	58	5.5 cm
56	61	6 cm
62	65	6.5 cm
68	68	7 cm
74	72	7.5 cm
80	75	8 cm
86	78	8.5 cm
92	81	9 cm
98	83	9 cm
104	85	9 cm

The motif is embroidered in the middle of the main body height, not right down against the brim and not right up at the top. More about that on the next page.

PART 3: HOW TO EMBROIDER THE MOTIF

The hat is now fully knitted, all one colour. You add the motif with duplicate stitch: a stitch that sits on top of the knitted stitches and looks knitted in. One square in the chart on the next page is one stitch on the hat. Use the blunt tapestry needle and a length of yarn about 40–50 cm.

HOW TO WORK ONE STITCH

1

come up here



Bring the needle up from below, at the base of the stitch (the root of the V).

2

under the stitch above



Pass the needle under both legs of the stitch right above. Pull the yarn through.

3

down the same hole



Bring the needle down into the same hole you came up. Done! The white V now lies on top of the red stitch.

GOOD TIPS

- Do not pull the yarn tight. The V should sit loose and relaxed on top of the stitch, not tight.
- Embroider row by row: finish one horizontal row of the chart before moving up to the next.
- Leave a 5 cm tail hanging on the inside at the start and end, weave in the ends when you are done.
- Count squares in the chart and stitches on the hat with your finger, twice if needed. Counting right is half the job.

A stitch come out wrong? Just pull it gently back out and try again.

THE CHARTS AND PLACEMENT

HOW TO PLACE THE MOTIF

Count the stitches around and find the middle (half of the «Main body» number on page 8), that becomes centre front, the middle of the forehead. Centre the chart around this point, with the same number of background stitches on each side. Embroider row 1 (the bottom of the chart) in the middle of the main body height, see page 8.

CHART: NORGE (29 STITCHES X 7 ROUNDS)

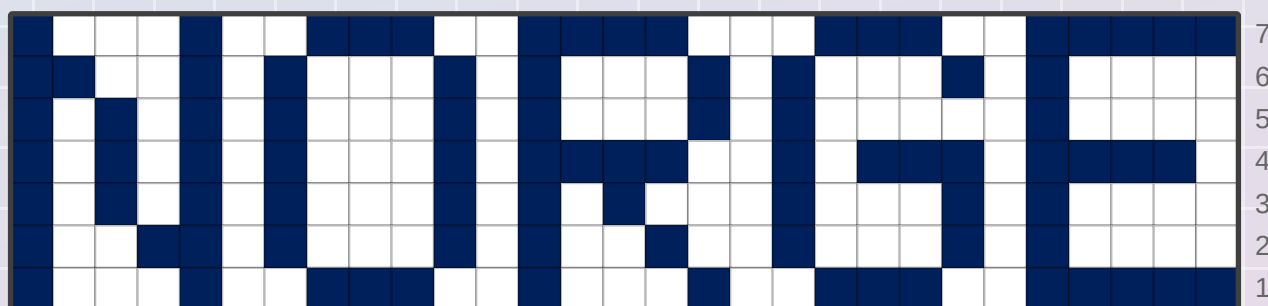


CHART: NORWAY (35 STITCHES X 7 ROUNDS)

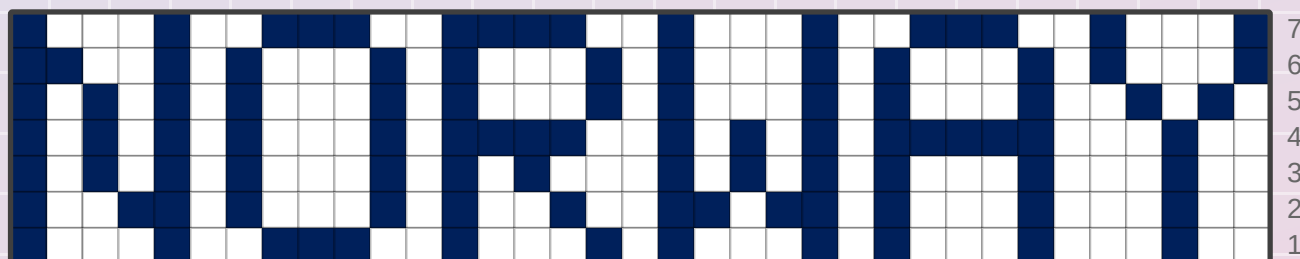
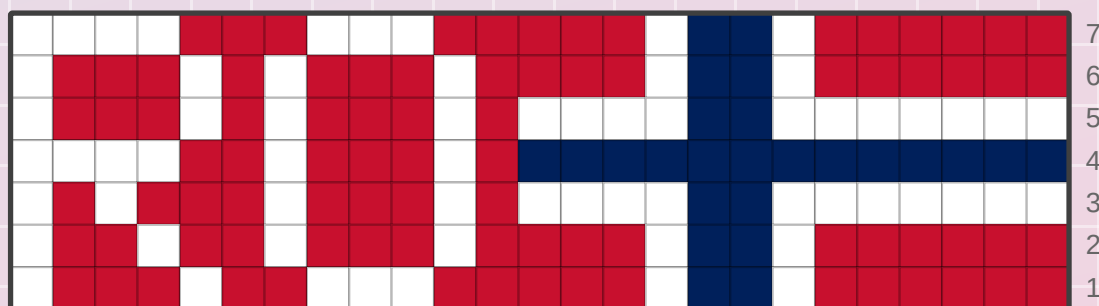


CHART: RO + FLAG (25 STITCHES X 7 ROUNDS)



Read all charts from the bottom up, just like the stitches in the knitting. Work each row from right to left. White square = embroider white (or navy for the RO brim). Coloured square = skip it, that is where the main colour shows through.

PART 4: THE CROWN

- 1 When the main body measures the value in the table on page 8, knit one setup round: decrease the number of stitches given in the «Decrease» column in the table below, evenly spaced around the whole round.
- 2 Divide the remaining stitches into 7 equal sections. Place a stitch marker between each section (7 markers in total, plus the one at the start of the round).
- 3 Knit to 2 stitches before each marker, knit these 2 together. Repeat at all 7 markers, giving 7 decreases per round.
- 4 Sizes 50–68: knit 1 plain round with no decreases after the first 3 decrease rounds, then decrease on every round after that. Sizes 74–104: knit 1 plain round after the first 4 decrease rounds, then decrease every round after that.
- 5 Continue until 7 stitches (one per section) remain. Cut the yarn leaving a generous tail, thread it through the remaining stitches with a tapestry needle, pull tight and fasten off securely on the inside.

TABLE: SETUP BEFORE THE CROWN

Size	Stitches before top	Decrease	Stitches after
50	58	Dec 2 st	56
56	61	Dec 5 st	56
62	65	Dec 2 st	63
68	68	Dec 5 st	63
74	72	Dec 2 st	70
80	75	Dec 5 st	70
86	78	Dec 1 st	77
92	81	Dec 4 st	77
98	83	Dec 6 st	77
104	85	Dec 1 st	84

CARE AND FINAL CHECK

FINISHING

Weave in all loose ends securely on the inside, both after the brim stripes and after the embroidery. Check that the embroidered stitches sit loose and relaxed on top of the knitting, not tight.

CARE

Wash following the yarn's recommendation, often 30°C on a gentle cycle in a wash bag, or by hand. Do not tumble dry. Shape the hat over a bowl or glass of the right size and let it dry flat or on the form.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ The head measurement has been checked, not just age
- ☐ The swatch matches 17 stitches x 22 rounds over 10 cm
- ☐ The brim has the flared edge from the decrease round
- ☐ The motif is embroidered with duplicate stitch, centred at centre front
- ☐ All embroidered stitches lie loose, not tight
- ☐ The top is pulled tight and well fastened off

Congratulations, you have knitted and embroidered your very own kids' bucket hat!



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